

REPORT OF OVERSEER OF POOR.

TO THE HONORABLE MAYOR AND CITY COUNCIL:

GENTLEMEN:—In accordance with established custom, and in harmony with city ordinance, I beg to submit to you and through you to the taxpayers of our city, a report of the expenditures for the support of the poor for the municipal year ending January 31, 1902.

The total amount expended for the year is \$2,325.95, which may be briefly summarized as follows:

Maintainance of inmates of alms house,	\$771.37
Supplies for alms house, - - -	162.89
Boarders at private houses, - - -	427.50
Bills from other towns in the State,	168.64
Burials, - - - - -	15.50
Supplies to families, including fuel, groceries, clothing, etc., - - -	843.05

A very large part of the last item was expended the first two months of the municipal year; this was made necessary by the fact that more than the usual number of families were destitute during the period named, a condition brought about largely by lack of work in our canning factories the previous season. It must not be forgotten that quite a percentage of Eastport's population are a class of people whose daily food depends for its continuance upon their daily earnings, and the margin between them and pauperism is but the loss of part of a seasons work. Happily the season just past has

Digitized by Google

been a lucrative one for the laborers in the sardine factories, and to-day only five families are receiving aid from the City, which is the smallest number ever known in the City's history, at this season of the year.

The Alms House now contains eleven persons, all of whom are being well cared for by the Master and Matron, Mr. and Mrs. John W. Whalen. Besides the inmates of the Alms House, we have four persons being boarded at private houses.